



CHENNAI | Burying the Hatchet

Tamil Nadu's feuding ruling family has decided to put away the gloves. Since May last year, the family of Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi and his grand-nephews Dayanidhi and Kalanidhi Maran fought bitterly, in public and in private. It cost Dayanidhi his job as Union telecom minister and triggered fears that the Marans could hurt the DMK with their media power. But the hatchet has been buried following a peace deal brokered by Selvi, Karunanidhi's daughter who is also aunt to Dayanidhi and Kalanidhi. Relations turned bitter when the party patriarch felt that the Marans were using the family owned SUN TV to drive a wedge between his children. The two sides have been at daggers drawn since then. Karunanidhi, who is to face a tough Parliament election next year, wants peace since the family feud has left the DMK in tatters. Worse, the Marans were seen getting close to AIADMK chief J. Jayalithaa. The rapprochement, however, throws up a few questions. Will Dayanidhi regain his berth in the Union Cabinet? What will be Kanimozhi's position in the party if Dayanidhi Maran regains is control? Both Karunanidhi and the Marans are keeping their lips sealed as the ugly family duel is laid to rest. For the time being at least. *by S. Senthil Kumar*

KARUNANIDHI (SITTING) AND HIS GRAND-NEPHEWS DAYANIDHI AND KALANIDHI HAVE PATCHED UP

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crore rupees is being spent by the BJP Government in Karnataka to build five-bedroom bungalows for "homeless" ministers.